

MYASTHENIA GRAVIS

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- **An autoimmune disease of neuromuscular junction** caused by antibodies to cholinergic receptors.
- **Characterised by grave weakness of muscle** due to inability of neuromuscular junction to transmit impulses.

CAUSES

- Caused due to the development of **autoantibodies (IgG autoantibodies)** against receptors of acetylcholine.



- Antibodies **prevent binding of acetylcholine** with its receptors or **destroy the receptors**.

SYMPTOMS

Muscles More Susceptible :—

- a. Muscles of neck
- b. Limbs
- c. Eyeballs
- d. Muscles for eyelid movements, chewing, swallowing, speech & respiration

Clinical Manifestations :—

- a. **Slow and weak** muscular contraction.
- b. **Inability to maintain prolonged contraction** of skeletal muscle.
- c. **Quick fatigability**.
- d. **Weakness & fatigability** of arms & legs.
- e. **Double vision & droopy eyelids** (*weakness of ocular muscles*).
- f. **Difficulty in swallowing**.
- g. **Difficulty in speech**.

TREATMENT

- **By administration of cholinesterase inhibitors** such as **neostigmine & pyridostigmine**.

